

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET D — ASSERTION & REASONING SPECIAL****CHAPTER 05: STATE AND SOCIETY UP TO 1000 CE****TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES****MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS****SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-D-05****Student's Name:** _____**Roll No.:** _____**Class & Section:** Class IX - _____**Date of Exam:** _____**Invigilator's Sign:** _____**General Instructions (SET D - Assertion & Reasoning Special):**

1. The question paper comprises **25 Assertion-Reasoning Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Each question consists of two statements — **Assertion (A)** and **Reason (R)**.
3. Select the correct option from the following 4 standardized choices:
 - **(A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(C)** Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 - **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.
4. **Section A (Q1 – Q10):** Core Concepts & Theoretical Principles.
5. **Section B (Q11 – Q18):** Evidentiary Proofs, Case Inferences & Historical/Geographical Mechanisms.
6. **Section C (Q19 – Q25):** Advanced Conceptual Nuances & Institutional/Analytical Complexities.
7. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
8. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

STANDARD DIRECTIONS FOR ALL 25 ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS:

- (A)** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
(D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

SECTION A: CORE THEORETICAL PRINCIPLES (Q.1 TO Q.10) [10 MARKS]**Q.1****Assertion (A):** In the Early Vedic period, the political authority of the Rajan was checked by popular assemblies.**Reason (R):** The Sabha and Samiti deliberated on military campaigns, distributed booty, and selected tribal leaders.

- (A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.2

Assertion (A): Magadha emerged as the most preeminent and powerful Mahajanapada in ancient North India.

Reason (R): Magadha possessed rich iron ore deposits in its vicinity, fertile Gangetic alluvium for high crop yields, and dense forests supplying timber and war elephants.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.3

Assertion (A): The Vajji confederacy was governed as an absolute hereditary monarchy.

Reason (R): Vajji was a Gana-Sangha (oligarchic republic) where power was shared among a council of elected clan chiefs called Rajas.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.4

Assertion (A): Kautilya's Arthashastra articulates the Saptanga theory of the state comprising seven essential elements.

Reason (R): According to Kautilya, a viable state requires Swami (King), Amatya (Ministers), Janapada (Territory & People), Durga (Fort), Kosha (Treasury), Danda (Army), and Mitra (Ally).

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.5

Assertion (A): Emperor Ashoka abandoned the policy of Bherighosha (conquest by war) in favor of Dhammaghosha (conquest by righteousness).

Reason (R): Ashoka was deeply remorseful after witnessing the massive slaughter, captivity, and human misery caused by the Kalinga War.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.6

Assertion (A): Ashoka used Sanskrit exclusively in all of his royal pillar and rock edicts across the Mauryan Empire.

Reason (R): To reach ordinary subjects directly, Ashoka utilized local vernacular Prakrit scripts (Brahmi and Kharosthi) in India, as well as Greek and Aramaic in the northwest.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.7

Assertion (A): The Gupta period is often described as the classical golden age of ancient Indian cultural and scientific achievements.

Reason (R): During the Gupta era, major advancements were achieved in astronomy, mathematics, metallurgy, sculpture, and classical Sanskrit literature.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.8

Assertion (A): Aryabhata stated that the Earth is stationary and located at the geometric center of the universe.

Reason (R): Aryabhata proposed that the spherical Earth rotates on its own axis, causing the apparent daily rising and setting of the stars and sun.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.9

Assertion (A): The Chola village administration at Uttaramerur selected committee members through a democratic secret ballot system using electronic machines.

Reason (R): Uttaramerur inscriptions document the Kudavolai system where palm-leaf tickets containing names of eligible candidates were drawn from a pot by a young boy.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.10

Assertion (A): The Allahabad Pillar Inscription (Prayag Prashasti) composed by Harishena extols the military conquests of Chandragupta Maurya.

Reason (R): The Prayag Prashasti was composed in praise of the Gupta emperor Samudragupta, detailing his extensive military campaigns across northern and southern India.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION B: EVIDENTIARY PROOFS & MECHANISMS (Q.11 TO Q.18) [8 MARKS]**Q.11**

Assertion (A): The Mauryan Empire maintained an elaborate centralized espionage and surveillance system.

Reason (R): Kautilya believed secret informants (Gudhapurushas) were vital to prevent administrative corruption, detect treason, and monitor provincial governors.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.12

Assertion (A): Land grants (Agraharas and Brahmadeyas) in the post-Gupta era contributed to political decentralization and feudal tendencies.

Reason (R): Rulers transferred not only revenue collection rights but also judicial and administrative authority over villages to religious beneficiaries and feudatories.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.13

Assertion (A): In ancient India, merchant guilds were known as 'Shrenis'.

Reason (R): Shrenis trained apprentices, established price and quality standards, maintained private militias, and served as banking institutions for public deposits.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.14

Assertion (A): The Mehrauli Iron Pillar in Delhi exhibits exceptional metallurgical expertise due to its total lack of rusting over 1,600 years.

Reason (R): Ancient Indian metallurgists created wrought iron with high phosphorus content and low sulfur, forming a protective passive film of misawite on its surface.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.15

Assertion (A): Emperor Harshavardhana successfully conquered the Deccan by defeating Pulakeshin II on the banks of the Narmada.

Reason (R): The Aihole inscription composed by Ravikirti records that the Chalukya king Pulakeshin II decisively checked Harsha's southward military advance.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.16

Assertion (A): Ashoka's 12th Major Rock Edict advocates for the promotion of mutual tolerance and respect among diverse religious sects.

Reason (R): Ashoka asserted that praising one's own religious sect while condemning others damages one's own faith more severely.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.17

Assertion (A): The Chinese pilgrim Xuanzang visited India during the reign of Chandragupta Maurya.

Reason (R): Xuanzang studied Buddhist scriptures at Nalanda University during the reign of King Harshavardhana in the 7th century CE.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.18

Assertion (A): The Chola Navy under Rajendra I conducted naval expeditions across the Bay of Bengal against the Srivijaya Kingdom in Southeast Asia.

Reason (R): Chola naval campaigns were launched to protect maritime trade routes and eliminate piratical trade blockades between South India and Song dynasty China.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION C: ADVANCED NUANCES & INSTITUTIONAL COMPLEXITIES (Q.19 TO Q.25) [7 MARKS]**Q.19**

Assertion (A): The transition from the Early Vedic pastoral economy to the Later Vedic sedentary agrarian economy was driven by iron technology.

Reason (R): Iron axes and iron-tipped ploughshares enabled the clearing of dense tropical forests and cultivation of hard alluvial soils in the middle Gangetic basin.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.20

Assertion (A): The caste (Jati) hierarchy in ancient India was completely static and prohibited any form of occupational or social mobility.

Reason (R): Inscriptions, such as the Mandasor inscription of silk weavers, show that craft guilds could migrate, adopt alternative professions, and enhance their social status.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.21

Assertion (A): Coins issued by the Indo-Greek rulers introduced portraiture and bilingual inscriptions in ancient Indian numismatics.

Reason (R): Indo-Greek coins carried realistic portraits of reigning monarchs on the obverse and Greek legends alongside Kharosthi/Prakrit translations on the reverse.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.22

Assertion (A): The monolithic rock-cut Kailash Temple at Ellora was constructed by building stone blocks from the bottom ground up.

Reason (R): Rashtrakuta sculptors excavated the temple out of a single basalt cliff, carving downward from the top summit to the base without scaffolding.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.23

Assertion (A): Kautilya's Arthashastra advises that the king should prioritize personal luxury and amusement over administrative justice.

Reason (R): The Arthashastra famously states: 'In the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare his welfare.'

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.24

Assertion (A): Sangam literature provides invaluable contemporary insights into the socioeconomic and political life of early Tamilakam.

Reason (R): Sangam poetry classifies landscapes into five ecological eco-zones (Tinais), each associated with distinct subsistence activities, social customs, and moods.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.25

Assertion (A): The Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur was built by the Pallava king Narasimhavarman I.

Reason (R): The Brihadisvara Temple, dedicated to Lord Shiva, was commissioned by the Chola emperor Rajaraja I in 1010 CE as a monumental architectural masterpiece.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET D)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & HISTORICAL/GEOGRAPHICAL CAUSAL EXPLANATIONS (SET D)

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the democratic and deliberative role of tribal assemblies in restraining early Vedic kings.
Q.2	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the comprehensive geographical, material, and military factors behind Magadha's hegemony.
Q.3	(D)	Assertion is false: Vajji was an oligarchic Gana-Sangha, not an absolute monarchy. Reason is true: The Lichchhavi clan chiefs ruled collegially.
Q.4	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and defines the seven constituent limbs of the sovereign state in ancient Indian political philosophy.
Q.5	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the historical and ethical transformation recorded in Ashoka's Major Rock Edict XIII.
Q.6	(D)	Assertion is false: Ashoka did not use Sanskrit; he used Prakrit, Greek, and Aramaic. Reason is true: Edicts were composed in regional vernaculars for public comprehension.
Q.7	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and describes the remarkable intellectual and cultural zenith represented by Aryabhata, Kalidasa, and the Mehrauli iron pillar.
Q.8	(D)	Assertion is false: Aryabhata rejected the geostatic dogma. Reason is true: He correctly posited diurnal axial rotation of the Earth.
Q.9	(D)	Assertion is false: It was an ancient lottery drawing, not modern electronic voting. Reason is true: The Kudavolai pot-ticket drawing system is detailed in Uttaramerur inscriptions.
Q.10	(D)	Assertion is false: Prayag Prashasti praises Samudragupta, not Chandragupta Maurya. Reason is true: Harishena was Samudragupta's court poet.
Q.11	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the administrative security rationale detailed in the Arthashastra.
Q.12	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the socioeconomic mechanism of Indian feudalism (Samanta system).
Q.13	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and outlines the multifaceted commercial, regulatory, and financial functions of craft guilds.
Q.14	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the chemical metallurgical explanation for the pillar's rust resistance.
Q.15	(D)	Assertion is false: Harsha was defeated by Pulakeshin II at the Narmada River. Reason is true: The Aihole inscription celebrates Pulakeshin II's victory over Harsha.
Q.16	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and reflects the noble ecumenical ethics inscribed in Ashoka's Major Rock Edict XII.
Q.17	(D)	Assertion is false: Xuanzang visited Harsha's court, while Megasthenes visited Chandragupta Maurya. Reason is true: Xuanzang spent years at Nalanda under Harsha's patronage.
Q.18	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the geopolitical and mercantile motivation behind the Chola maritime expedition.
Q.19	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the materialist technological transition to the Second Urbanisation.
Q.20	(D)	Assertion is false: Historical evidence shows flexibility and corporate mobility for guilds. Reason is true: Mandasor weavers changed occupations without loss of prestige.

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.21	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the significant artistic and numismatic innovation brought by Hellenistic-Indian kingdoms.
Q.22	(D)	Assertion is false: It was carved top-down into a solid basalt cliff, not assembled with stone blocks. Reason is true: The top-down excavation required zero block masonry.
Q.23	(D)	Assertion is false: The text advocates tireless royal devotion to public duty. Reason is true: The Arthashastra anchors royal legitimacy in public welfare.
Q.24	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and describes the sophisticated ecological classification system of early Tamil Sangam poetry.
Q.25	(D)	Assertion is false: It was built by Rajaraja Chola I, not the Pallavas. Reason is true: Rajaraja I constructed the grand granite temple at Thanjavur.